

Salary, Offer Letter & First 30 Days

From offer to signed contract to your first month at work — everything you need to know.

SESSION 2 QUICK CHECK

Did you practice your self-introduction?
Did you research any companies?
Drop your update in the chat! 💬

OPENING POLL

Have you ever received an offer letter or negotiated a salary?

A — Yes, I have received an offer before

B — No, this is all new to me

C — Seen one but don't understand it

D — Tried negotiating, didn't know how

What is an Offer Letter?

A legal document — read every line before you sign

01



Designation

Check your exact job title. If interview said 'Software Engineer' but letter says 'Trainee' — ask HR immediately.

02



CTC & Salary Breakup

Always ask for detailed salary breakup. Never sign with just a CTC number — you need to know your in-hand amount.

03



Date of Joining

Confirm the date is realistic for you. If you need more time for formalities or relocation — discuss it now, not after signing.

04



Location

Check which city and office. Watch for 'transferable to any location' clauses if you have location constraints.

05



Notice Period

Typically 1-3 months for freshers. This affects your flexibility to move later. Know this before joining.

06



Probation Period

Usually 3-6 months. Benefits like PF or leaves may differ during probation. Read this section carefully.

07



Bond / Service Agreement

MOST CRITICAL. If a bond exists — understand the duration, penalty amount, and conditions clearly before signing.

08



Terms & Conditions

Read confidentiality, non-compete, and IP clauses. These are standard but you should know what you are agreeing to.

Golden Rule: If anything differs from what was discussed verbally — ask HR before signing. A good company will always explain.

CTC vs In-Hand Salary

The difference that shocks every fresher on their first payday

6 LPA CTC $\neq$ 50,000/month in hand. Your actual take-home is typically between **35,000 – 39,000/month.**

CTC — Cost to Company (6 LPA)

Basic Salary (40% of CTC) ₹20,000/mo

Foundation — everything calculated from this

HRA (50% of Basic) ₹10,000/mo

House Rent Allowance — partially tax exempt

Special Allowance ₹12,000/mo

Top-up component — fully taxable

Company PF (12% of Basic) ₹2,400/mo

In CTC but NOT in your monthly salary

Gratuity ₹1,000/mo

Paid only after 5 years of service

Health Insurance Premium ₹1,500/mo

Medical benefit included in CTC

In-Hand / Take-Home Salary

GROSS SALARY

Basic + HRA + Special Allowance = ₹42,000/month

DEDUCTIONS

Your PF Contribution (12% of Basic) — ₹2,400

Professional Tax — ₹200

TDS (if applicable) — varies

ACTUAL IN-HAND SALARY

₹35,000 – ₹39,000 / month

 **Always ask HR: 'What will my monthly in-hand salary be?' before signing.**

PF deducted monthly is NOT lost — it builds up in your account and is returned with interest when you leave or retire.

Salary Package Components Explained

Know every component before you sign — no surprises later



HRA

House Rent Allowance

40-50% of basic. Partially tax-exempt if you pay rent and submit receipts. One of the best tax-saving benefits.



LTA

Leave Travel Allowance

Tax-exempt if you travel within India and submit bills. Claimable twice in a 4-year block. Keep all travel tickets.



Joining Bonus

One-time Sign-on Bonus

Paid on joining or post-probation. CRITICAL: Usually recoverable if you leave within 6-12 months. Read the condition carefully.



Retention Bonus

Stay-on Incentive

Paid to existing employees for staying a defined period. Not on day one — but you will encounter this as you grow.



Variable / Bonus

Performance-Linked Pay

10-20% of CTC. NOT guaranteed — depends on your performance and company performance. Always check fixed vs variable split.



Meal Allowance

Food Coupon / Sodexo

₹1,500-2,200/month. Partially tax-exempt. Submit meal bills or use food coupons. Small but adds up over a year.



WFH Allowance

Internet / Home Office

₹1,000-1,500/month post-pandemic. Covers internet and electricity costs. Partially tax-exempt.



Health Insurance

Medical Cover

Premium included in CTC. Usually covers ₹3-5 lakh per year for you and sometimes family. Check coverage amount carefully.

Golden Formula: Fixed In-Hand + Variable Conditions + Tax-Exempt Components = True Value of Your Offer

Salary Negotiation

When to do it, how to do it, and exactly what to say

 **WHEN TO NEGOTIATE** — After they make you a formal offer. Before you sign. Never during the interview itself.

01

Research First

Know the market rate for your role and city. Use AmbitionBox, Glassdoor, LinkedIn Salary. Walk in with data — not just a feeling.

02

Start Positively

Express genuine excitement about the offer first. Never open with a complaint. Set a collaborative tone — you are having a conversation, not a fight.

03

State Your Ask Clearly

Say the number or range confidently. Give a brief reason — your research, skills, or a competing offer. Be direct and professional.

04

Be Patient

After you state your ask — wait. Do not immediately lower your number to fill silence. Let them respond. Patience signals confidence.

05

Be Flexible

If they cannot move on salary — ask for something else. Earlier appraisal, joining bonus, better designation, extra leave, or faster confirmation on variable.

WHAT TO SAY — Exact Scripts

Standard Fresher

"Thank you for this offer — I am genuinely excited. Based on my research, I was expecting something closer to X LPA. Is there any flexibility on the fixed component?"

With Competing Offer

"Your company is my first preference. I want to be transparent — I have another offer at X LPA. Could you match or come closer so I can make this decision confidently?"

If Budget is Fixed

"I understand completely. Could we look at an earlier 6-month review, a joining bonus, or an additional leave day? I want to make this work."

Never negotiate over WhatsApp • Never lie about competing offers • Never give ultimatums • Never negotiate after signing

How to Handle Multiple Offers

Compare smartly — the highest CTC is not always the best offer

THE 5-PARAMETER COMPARISON FRAMEWORK



01 Fixed In-Hand Salary

Not CTC — calculate actual monthly take-home for both offers after all deductions. This is what you live on every month.



02 Growth & Appraisal Cycle

How often are appraisals? What is the average increment for good performers? A company giving 20% annual increments will overtake a higher CTC company in 2 years.



03 Learning & Skill Development

What technologies? Live products or internal tools? Training programs? Skills you build in year 1-2 define your market value for the next 10 years.



04 Company Stability

How old is the company? Is it funded? Check LinkedIn, Glassdoor, AmbitionBox. How long do employees typically stay? A stable company with lower CTC may be smarter than a high-CTC startup.



05 Culture & Work Environment

What did you feel during the interview? Were people warm and honest? Culture affects your daily happiness and productivity every single day. Do not underestimate this.

Declining Gracefully: 'Thank you for this opportunity. After careful consideration I have decided to pursue another role that is a closer fit. I have great respect for your organisation and hope our paths cross again.'

Common Mistakes Freshers Make After Getting an Offer

Avoid these — your professional reputation starts here

01

X Verbally accepting then backing out silently

✓ **Do this instead:** Always decline gracefully and early. Call HR directly. Never ghost a company.

02

X Signing without reading the offer letter

✓ **Do this instead:** Read every line. Every clause. If unclear — ask HR before signing, not after.

03

X Sharing offer letter publicly on social media

✓ **Do this instead:** It is a confidential document. Celebrate your success but protect the document.

04

X Telling current workplace too early

✓ **Do this instead:** Wait until you are ready to formally resign. Resign professionally, serve notice fully.

05

X Background verification errors or delays

✓ **Do this instead:** Submit all documents accurately and promptly. Never inflate any details — companies verify everything.

06

X Negotiating after signing

✓ **Do this instead:** Once signed, conversation is closed. Negotiate before signing — that is your only window.

07

X Not serving notice period properly

✓ **Do this instead:** Deliver fully until your last day. Get your relieving letter and experience letter before leaving.

08

X Going silent between offer and joining date

✓ **Do this instead:** Stay responsive. Complete all pre-joining formalities promptly. Read any onboarding material sent.

Your First 30 Days at a New Job

First impressions last a very long time — build them deliberately

Week 1

Observe, Listen & Absorb

- ✓ Arrive 10-15 mins early on day one. Dress formally.
- ✓ Remember names — write them down if needed
- ✓ Attend every meeting — just observe and listen
- ✓ Understand team structure — who does what
- ✓ Set up your environment and read all documentation
- ✓ Ask thoughtful questions — show you tried first

Weeks 2-3

Start Contributing

- ✓ Proactively ask for a small task to get started
- ✓ Deliver on time — communicate blockers early
- ✓ Follow team coding standards and conventions
- ✓ Participate actively in stand-ups and discussions
- ✓ Build relationships — have lunch with different people
- ✓ Share ideas respectfully — earn context first

Week 4

Reflect, Align & Plan

- ✓ Request a 1-on-1 with your manager
- ✓ Ask: 'Anything I should do differently?'
- ✓ Ask: 'What should I focus on next 60 days?'
- ✓ Ask: 'How does my first month compare to expectations?'
- ✓ Set personal goals for your first 3 months
- ✓ Write them down and review them regularly

Mindset: Be a learner first. Be humble but not invisible. Be patient with yourself. Everyone in that room felt lost on day one.

Do's & Don'ts After Receiving an Offer

Your final checklist — protect your offer and your reputation

✓ DO THIS



Read the offer letter completely before signing every single line



Negotiate before signing — that is your only window



Inform HR of your decision within the given timeframe



Decline gracefully if not joining — call HR, thank them, wish them well



Complete all pre-joining formalities promptly and accurately



Inform your references before giving their names to the company



Keep copies of all documents — offer letter, salary slips, relieving letter



Stay responsive between offer acceptance and joining date

✗ DON'T DO THIS



Share your offer letter publicly on social media or WhatsApp groups



Verbally accept and then back out silently — always communicate



Lie on background verification documents — companies verify everything



Tell your current workplace about the new offer before you are ready to resign



Negotiate after signing — once signed, terms are accepted legally



Make major financial commitments based on offer alone — wait for first salary



Badmouth previous company or college during joining or induction



Skip induction sessions — they give you valuable context and your first network

Questions?



Drop them in the Zoom chat or raise your hand

✓ Session 3 Today

- ✓ What is an offer letter & what to check
- ✓ CTC vs In-Hand salary explained
- ✓ All salary components decoded
- ✓ Salary negotiation scripts
- ✓ Handling multiple offers smartly
- ✓ 8 mistakes to avoid after offer
- ✓ First 30 days — week by week
- ✓ Do's & Don'ts after receiving offer

📄 Full Series Recap

Session 1

Resume • ATS • Formatting • Customisation

Session 2

Approach HR • Types of Interview • Self Intro • Body Language • HR Questions • Tough Questions

Session 3

Offer Letter • Salary • Negotiation • Multiple Offers
• First 30 Days

Resume → Interview → Offer
You are now fully prepared. 🚀

📄 Final Homework

1. Update your resume — test on Jobscan, aim 70%+
2. Practice self-introduction 10 times — record yourself
3. Research your target salary on AmbitionBox or Glassdoor
4. Write answers to 5 HR questions in your own words

Go get that offer.
You have earned it! 🚀